

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 1 of 17

1.0 OBJECTIVES

- 1.1 To ensure that PSHSS continuously operates in accordance with the specified policies, procedures and external requirements in meeting institutional goals and objectives.
- 1.2 To ensure that improvements to the Quality Management System are identified, implemented and suitable to achieve objectives.

2.0 SCOPE

This procedure employs the Plan-Do-Check-Act (PDCA) approaches, a management method for the control and continual improvement of processes, in the conduct of Internal Quality Audit (IQA), and complies with the Internal Audit requirements of ISO 9001:2015, known as Quality Management Systems – Requirements.

3.0 POLICIES

3.1 Audit Program

The organization shall establish an Audit Program that reflects the arrangement for a set of one or more Internal Quality Audits (IQAs) for a specific timeframe, including other activities related to Quality Management System. The implementation of the Audit Program shall include the:

- 1) objectives of the program;
- 2) determination of risks and opportunities associated with the program;
- 3) scope of the audit/s within the program;
- 4) schedule of the audit/s;
- 5) audit method/s to be employed (on-site or remote);
- 6) criteria for selecting the audit team members;
- 7) relevant documented information; and
- 8) audit criteria

The last two items may be available only upon creation and approval of the Audit Plan.



VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 2 of 17

3.1.1 The Internal Quality Audit (IQA) shall mean Quality Management System Audit in this procedure and be conducted at least once a year prior to the scheduled Management Review.

3.1.1.1 The extent and frequency to which the Internal Quality Audit (IQA) is conducted may be changed depending on the:

- 1) complexity of the process;
- 2) type of risks and opportunities;
- 3) result of the previous audit; and
- 4) the level of performance of the area; or
- 5) as deemed appropriate by the Quality Management Representative (QMR).

3.1.2 There shall be an Audit Team responsible in undertaking an Internal Quality Audit (IQA). The Internal Quality Auditors, headed by a Lead Auditor, are the members of the Audit Team and shall possess the following characteristics:

- 1) Adept at the elements of ISO 9001:2015;
- 2) Adequately trained to conduct an Internal Quality Audit (IQA); and
- 3) Have no direct responsibility on their assigned audit areas.

3.1.3 The Audit Program shall be reviewed and improved, if necessary, to assess whether its objectives have been achieved.

3.2 Audit Plan

In preparing Internal Quality Audit (IQA) activities, each scheduled Internal Quality Audit (IQA), as reflected in the Audit Program, shall have a corresponding Audit Plan.

3.2.1 The number of set of Audit Plan to be prepared corresponds to the number of Internal Quality Audit (IQA) planned within the year (e.g., two (2) IQAs per year shall have two (2) Audit Plans, three (3) IQAs per year shall have three (3) Audit Plans).



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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 3 of 17

3.2.2 The Audit Plan shall show the structure of the description of the activities and itinerary for the execution of Internal Quality Audit (IQA). It should address or reference the minimum requirements in creating the Audit Program and provide detailed information for the following:

- 1) date and duration for the actual audit per area
- 2) scope of the audit (ISO clauses/procedures)
- 3) area/process/activity/committee/QMS elements
- 4) name of auditor assigned to conduct the audit for a particular area (the number of auditors assigned to a particular area depends on the size of the area)

3.2.3 The Audit Team shall present the Audit Plan to the auditees. If there are issues with the Audit plan, it shall be resolved between the Lead Auditor and the auditees.

3.2.4 The Audit Plan details the indicative schedule and may be subject to change as the audit progresses. Under these circumstances, the Audit Team shall review, accept, as appropriate, present and agree on the change with the auditee.

3.3 Responsibilities

3.3.1 Quality Management Representative (QMR)

- 1) Reviews the Audit Program and the Audit Plan and signifies consensus on the audit activities by signing the documents;
- 2) Reviews the Audit Report submitted by the Lead Auditor prior to the scheduled Management Review;
- 3) Alongside concerned head, reviews and affirms effectiveness of the Correction or Corrective Action and Improvement/s taken, relative to the Audit Report submitted, by signing and closing out the accomplished Corrective Action Request (CAR) Form/Audit Observation Request (AOR) Form;



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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 4 of 17

- 4) Reviews the documentation on existing Quality Management System activities to determine their adequacy;
- 5) Conducts ISO 9001:2015 and Quality Management System Orientation or Re-orientation annually prior to the scheduled Internal Quality Audit;
- 6) Ensures that the Audit Plan is presented and shared with the auditees;
- 7) Monitors closure of all Audit Findings and follow up head concerned to ensure closure; and
- 8) Notifies attendees of the Management Review Meeting on the scheduled discussion of the Internal Quality Audit results.

3.3.2 Independent Process Reviewer

- 1) Audits the Internal Quality Audit (IQA) and Document Control processes;
- 2) Audits the Management Committee; and
- 3) Reviews the Audit Program and Audit Plan alongside Quality Management Representative and Audit Team prior to the approval by the Executive Director (OED)/Campus Director (campus level)

3.3.3 Lead Auditor

- 1) Prepares the Audit Program and the Audit Plan, in consultation with the Audit Team and the Quality Management Representative (QMR) and submits to the Executive Director (OED)/Campus Director (campus level) for approval;
- 2) Coordinates and agrees with the Unit Head concerned on the schedule of the audit;
- 3) Responsible for all phases of the audit and is authorized in making final decisions relative to the conduct of the audit ;
- 4) Assists the Executive Director (OED)/Campus Director (campus level) in the selection or appointment of members (Internal Quality Auditors) of the Audit Team;
- 5) Plans the audit, prepares working documents and briefs the Audit Team;



**MASTER
COPY**

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 5 of 17

- 6) Consolidates all audit findings and prepares the Audit Report and submits to the QMR for review;
- 7) Monitors Follow-up Audit conducted by the Audit Team on the issued Corrective Action Request (CAR) Form and/or Audit Observation Request (AOR) Form;
- 8) Reports to the Management any major obstacles encountered in the conduct of the audit;
- 9) Clearly, conclusively, and without undue delay, reports the audit result to the auditee;
- 10) Schedules Management Review Meeting and convenes the Management Committee, Audit Team, Quality Management Representative, and Heads to discuss the Internal Quality Audit results; and
- 11) Conducts the opening and closing meeting, as necessary.

3.3.4 Audit Team Members

- 1) Supports the Lead Auditor in the conduct of Internal Quality Audit and other related activities;
- 2) Communicates and clarifies audit requirements with the auditees;
- 3) Prepares audit checklists based on the requirements of the manuals and procedures, ISO 9001:2015 clauses, and applicable legal and statutory requirements;
- 4) Conducts Internal Quality Audit using checklists;
- 5) Checks and obtains consensus from Head or authorized representative on the audit findings;
- 6) Prepares the Corrective Action Request (CAR) Form for nonconformities and Audit Observation Request (AOR) Form for observations, suggestions, and comments raised during the conduct of Internal Quality Audit, and requires the auditee to act on it;
- 7) Prepares individual Internal Quality Audit report and provides a photocopy to the auditee;
- 8) Submits the individual Internal Quality Audit report to the Lead Auditor for consolidation, presentation, and discussion with the Quality Management Representative and Management Committee;



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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 6 of 17

- 9) Conducts Follow-up Audits of issued CARs and/or AORs and updates the forms accordingly;
- 10) Remains impartial and upholds integrity to factors that can influence the audit results and require more extensive auditing; and
- 11) Acts in an ethical and professional manner at all times.

3.3.5 Auditee

- 1) Attends opening and closing meeting conducted by the Audit Team;
- 2) Understands the objectives of the Internal Quality Audit as reflected in the Audit Plan;
- 3) Be aware of the scope of the Internal Quality Audit relative to the requirements of ISO 9001:2015 standard and the audit requirements on the creation, revision, control, maintenance, retention, and disposal of documented information;
- 4) Cooperates with the Audit Team for the achievement of the audit objectives;
- 5) Receives the Audit Report from the Audit Team and acts on the issued CAR or AOR in a timely manner upon consultation with the immediate head;
- 6) Ensures proper implementation of the Correction or Corrective Action and Improvement taken in addressing the nonconformities and observation/suggestion/comment, respectively; and
- 7) Updates the Audit Team and Quality Management Representative (QMR) on the status and progress of the CAR and/or AOR for review and closure (if action is deemed effective), otherwise revisit the Root Cause Analysis (RCA) and resubmit to the Audit Team.

3.4 Conduct of Internal Quality Audit

The process of conducting an Internal Quality Audit (IQA) employs a 4-stage PDCA cycle (Plan, Do, Check, Act). In each stage, the Audit Team shall execute the following activities:



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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 7 of 17

3.4.1 PLAN

3.4.1.1 In initiating the Internal Quality Audit, the Lead Auditor shall establish contact with the auditees and determine the feasibility of the audit.

3.4.1.2 The Audit Team shall prepare the Audit activities by conducting review of the documented information to gather information and understand the operations of the auditee. In this stage, the Audit Team shall create an Audit Plan detailing the following:

- 1) Audit objectives and scope;
- 2) Identification of the organizational units to be audited;
- 3) Roles and responsibilities/area of assignment of the Audit Team members;
- 4) References and criteria to be used during the audit;
- 5) Date, place where to conduct the audit and the expected time and duration;
- 6) The audit method to be used;
- 7) Date of Meeting with the Auditee; and
- 8) Date of Opening Meeting, Audit Results reporting, and Closing Meeting

3.4.1.3 The Audit Team members shall collect and review information relevant to their area of assignment and prepare the work documents including checklists. The checklists should be sufficient in addressing all elements of the Quality Management System within the audit scope. However, its use should not restrict the extent of the audit activities, which can change resulting from the information collected within the course of the audit.

The Audit Team shall keep all notes taken and recorded in during the conduct of the Internal Quality Audit (IQA). The notes shall be the basis for the actual IQA conducted and



VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 8 of 17

evidence against any Nonconformities seen during the audit.

3.4.2 DO

- 3.4.2.1 If necessary, assign guides and observers to accompany the Audit Team in the conduct of Internal Quality Audit. The guides and observers shall not influence or interfere with the conduct of the audit.

Observers are individuals assigned by the Lead Auditor to accompany the Audit Team during the conduct of the Internal Quality Audit (IQA) but do not act as auditors. These individuals should not interfere the course of the audit.

- 3.4.2.2 Opening Meeting.
The Audit Team shall conduct an Opening Meeting with the Quality Management Representative (QMR), Management Committee, and responsible process owners to be audited in order to:

- 1) Introduce the members of the Audit Team and their roles to the auditees;
- 2) Discuss on matters that need clarification and get the participants' agreement to the Audit Plan; and
- 3) Make sure that planned audit activities can be performed

The Lead Auditor may decide not to conduct the Opening Meeting and opt to send the Audit Plan through e-mail to the Management and responsible process owners for their advance review and comments.



VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 9 of 17

3.4.2.3 Audit Proper.

In the course of the Internal Quality Audit, the Lead Auditor should periodically communicate the progress to ensure timely resolution of any concerns to the auditee.

The conduct of Internal Quality Audit includes but not limited to the following activities:

- 1) Collection of evidences through interviews, examination of documented information, and observation of activities and conditions in the areas of concern.
- 2) Use of checklists and documented information as guides during the audit.

The auditor shall cite a specific example of requirements to be complied with in case there are nonconformities found based on the items required from the checklists.

- 3) Use of the following types of questions:

Open-ended questions that encourage the auditee to talk in order to gather information.

Probing questions in the form of follow-up questions to gain greater insights on the information provided by the auditee. It is also the focusing phase of the interview.

Closed-ended questions used to establish a final point on the information provided by the auditee. These questions normally are answerable by "yes or no". It is the final phase of the interview.

- 4) The auditors shall observe the following qualities in the conduct of Internal Quality Audit:
 - Politeness
 - Punctuality



**MASTER
COPY**

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 10 of 17

- Tactfulness
- Objectiveness
- Courteousness
- Exercise of fairness
- Respect for protocols
- Respect for confidentiality
- Respect for valid restrictions
- Respect for limits of authority

3.4.2.4 Closing Meeting.

After the completion of audit, the Audit Team should confer first to review the audit findings, agree on the conclusions, and prepare the recommendations before conducting the Closing Meeting.

- 1) The Quality Management Representative (QMR), Management Committee, and process owners (auditees) should attend the Closing Meeting;
- 2) The Lead Auditor shall preside over the Closing Meeting;
- 3) The Lead Auditor shall reiterate the objectives and scope of the audit and the reference standards used during the audit;
- 4) The auditors shall report their audit findings, comments, suggestions, and observations;
- 5) The time scale on the Correction or Corrective Actions and improvement recommendations agreed upon, if applicable; and
- 6) All queries and clarifications are resolved.

3.4.2.5 Preparation and Distribution of Audit Report

The Lead Auditor should consolidate all individual reports and present the audit findings, including good practices and related evidence, and the audit conclusion to the attendees of the Closing Meeting. After which, the Audit Team shall distribute the individual audit report to the auditee for the appropriate action. The Audit Team shall:

 **MASTER
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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 11 of 17

- 1) document all audit findings after all activities have been audited;
- 2) classify the audit findings as defined below and issue the appropriate CAR or AOR form;

Positive Findings/Aspects:

Items that are commendable or noteworthy as recognized by the auditor during the audit.

Opportunities for Improvement (OFI):

Areas for review only and recommended to be addressed if feasible or applicable on the part of the organization. No documented action response needed.

Observations/Comments/Suggestions:

Those gray areas that may lead to a nonconformity if not addressed. The Audit team shall trace or check these items in the next succeeding audit. The Audit Team shall issue and Audit Observation Request (AOR) Form and requires the auditee to address these items.

Minor Nonconformity:

Partial fulfillment of the requirements of the standard. The Audit Team shall require the auditee to provide and reflect the needed Correction in the CAR Form.

Major Nonconformity:

Non-fulfillment of the requirements of the standard or system breakdown and requires the auditee to provide immediate Correction to control the problem and Corrective Action, through a CAR Form, to ensure that it will not recur and occur in other areas of the organization. Recurrence of previous Minor Nonconformity shall fall under this classification.



**MASTER
COPY**

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 12 of 17

- 3) The Lead Auditor shall prepare a standard Audit Report that includes the date of audit, audit scope, objectives, references used, the members of the Audit Team, audit timetable, and the summary of all findings; and
- 4) The audit report shall have the following characteristics:
 - concise and factual
 - findings should be within the scope of the audit and substantiated by objective evidence;
 - reflects professionalism;
 - presented in a constructive manner; and
 - presents a true and fair view of the system implementation

3.4.3 CHECK

The Internal Quality Audit (IQA) is complete when all planned audit activities have been carried out. The QMSO shall keep and retain the audit report as documented information and dispose of or endorse to the Records Management Unit based on the Filing Chart.

3.4.4 ACT

- 3.4.4.1 The Audit Team shall monitor the implementation of the Audit Program and ensure to evaluate the following:
 - 1) whether the schedules are met and objectives are achieved;
 - 2) performance of the Audit Team;
 - 3) ability of the Audit Team to implement the audit plan;
 - 4) feedback from the auditees, auditors, and other relevant parties; and
 - 5) sufficiency and adequacy of documented information in the whole audit process.



**MASTER
COPY**

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 13 of 17

Given the information above, the Audit Team shall review the Audit program to assess whether its objectives have been achieved and improve (if necessary).

3.4.4.2 Responsibility in Handling the Audit Findings

- 1) The auditors shall only be responsible in identifying the audit findings.
- 2) The auditees shall be responsible in providing the necessary actions to close the audit findings, as appropriate.
- 3) The immediate head of the concerned auditee shall review the Correction or Corrective Actions, and needed improvements for adequacy prior implementation.
- 4) The auditees shall ensure that all improvement actions taken are implemented on the agreed date as reflected in the CAR or AOR Form.
- 5) The Audit Team shall conduct a Follow-Up Audit to ensure that Nonconformities do not recur. The dates by which the follow-up audit is to be conducted shall be agreed upon between the auditor and the auditee.
- 6) The results of the Correction or Corrective Actions and improvement actions shall be verified and monitored for effectiveness.
- 7) The Quality Management Representative (QMR) shall meet with the auditors and take overall responsibility for follow-up activities of audit results with the auditees. Follow-up action will not be considered complete/closed until all Corrections or Corrective Actions, and improvement actions have been implemented and the status has been reported to the Lead Auditor.



**MASTER
COPY**

VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 14 of 17

4.0 PROCEDURES

Responsibility	Activity
Executive Director/ Campus Director	1. Appoints employee to be the Lead Auditor.
	2. Appoints employees to be members of the Audit Team with the assistance of the Lead Auditor.
Audit Team member	3. Attends IQA training, if needed.
Lead Auditor	4. Prepares the Audit Program for the year and forwards to the Audit Team, Independent Process Reviewer, and QMR for review.
QMR/ Audit Team/ Independent Process Reviewer	5. Reviews the Audit Program and forwards to the Executive Director/Campus Director for approval.
Executive Director/ Campus Director	6. Approves the Audit Program.
Lead Auditor	7. Prepares the Audit Plan prior to the scheduled Internal Quality Audit (IQA) and forwards to the QMR, Audit Team, and Independent Process Reviewer for review.
QMR/ Audit Team/ Independent Process Reviewer	8. Reviews the Audit Plan and forwards to the Executive Director (OED) / Campus Director (campus level) for approval.



VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 15 of 17

Executive
Director/
Campus
Director

9. Approves the Audit Plan.

Lead Auditor

10. Conducts/presides the Opening Meeting.

Audit Team

11. Reviews the Quality Management System manual and procedures and other applicable legal and statutory requirements

12. Prepares the Audit Checklists and other work documents, as needed

13. Conducts the Internal Quality Audit (IQA)

14. Accomplishes CAR Form for Nonconformities, or AOR Form for observations/comments/suggestions found.

15. Gathers objective pieces of evidence to support findings, if applicable.

16. Discusses the findings with auditee for the conduct of Root Cause Analysis (RCA) and agrees on date of completion on Correction and/or Corrective Action / and improvement actions with the auditors.

17. Submits all CARs/AORs to the Lead Auditor.

Lead Auditor

18. Fills out the CAR Status Log and AOR Status Log.

19. Consolidates audit findings with the IQA Team.

Lead
Auditor/QMR

20. Conducts the Closing Meeting.

21. Presents and discusses the audit findings during the management review.



**MASTER
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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 16 of 17

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|--|---|
| Audit Team | 22. Conducts Follow-up Audit to monitor the effectiveness of the actions taken for the audit findings |
| QMR/
Immediate
Head of the
concerned
auditee | 23. Closes the CAR/AOR. |
| Lead
Auditor/QMR | 24. Updates the CAR Status Log and AOR Status Log. |

5.0 LIST OF FORMS AND REPORTS

5.1 Forms

- 5.1.1 Internal Audit Schedule for Calendar Year
- 5.1.2 Corrective Action Request (CAR) Form
- 5.1.3 Audit Observation Request (AOR) Form
- 5.1.4 Corrective Action Request (CAR) Status Log
- 5.1.5 Audit Observation Request (AOR) Status Log
- 5.1.6 IQA Auditor Performance Evaluation
- 5.1.7 Internal Quality Audit Plan

5.2 Reports

- 5.2.1 IQA Report



**MASTER
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VERSION NO. 2	MANUAL TITLE QUALITY MANUAL	DOCUMENT NO. QM 13.2
	DOCUMENT NAME INTERNAL QUALITY AUDIT	REVISION NO. 1
		EFFECTIVITY DATE June 23, 2024
		PAGE NO. 17 of 17

REVISION HISTORY

DCR No.	Section	Amendment/s	Revision No.	Implementation Date
-	Complete re-write of Version 1	Original Issue and Initial Implementation	0	February 1, 2020
21-00-023 23-00-020	-	Added Revision History; Complete review and reconstruction of the procedure to align with the PDCA	1	June 23, 2024



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